9.14 Compartment Syndrome*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "The pain is getting worse even with injections." **Objective** • Pain on passive muscle stretch • Tense, swollen compartment • Paresthesia	**ACTUAL** Ineffective peripheral tissue perfusion related to increased compartment pressure as evidenced by severe pain, tense swelling and paresthesia.	• Perfusion restored after fasciotomy.	• Report at once. • Keep the limb at heart level, not raised. • Remove or loosen tight dressings or cast as ordered. • Prepare for fasciotomy.	• Achieved when perfusion is restored.
Subjective • Rates pain 10/10 **Objective** • Opioids give no relief • Pain on passive stretch	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to ischemia as evidenced by pain disproportionate to injury.	• Pain relieved after decompression.	• Give analgesia as prescribed. • Reassess pain often. • Report pain that is not relieved immediately.	• Outcome reached once relieved.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Fasciotomy wound • Exposed muscle	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: open fasciotomy wounds.	• Wounds free of infection.	• Use sterile dressings. • Watch temperature and how the wound looks. • Give antibiotics as prescribed.	• Considered met if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.